

DAILY FINANCIAL BULLETIN

Global Macro & Crypto Market Intelligence

Wed, Aug 19 2026

RISK-OFF Rising volatility, weakness in technology shares and commodity-led geopolitical risks confirm a risk-off market regime.

The market remains in a risk-off posture: **VIX rose 4.28% to 15.84**, Nasdaq 100 futures fell **0.43%**, and SMH declined **4.09%**. The US 10-year Treasury yield stands at **4.706%**, down 1.8 basis points on the day, while the DXY eased to **99.53**. Brent crude advanced to **\$91.61** as uncertainty around the Strait of Hormuz keeps energy-supply and geopolitical risks in focus. Crypto total market capitalization is at **\$2.281 trillion**, up 0.19% over 24 hours, but the Fear & Greed Index remains in **Fear at 46**, with BTC dominance at 56.49%. The FOMC meeting minutes due on August 19 are the key catalyst for signals on the rate path and inflation risks; no new CPI, PPI, PCE or FOMC rate decision is scheduled this week.

STRATEGIC RESEARCH FOCUS

COMMODITIES

How far can Hormuz uncertainty reprice oil?

Slower Hormuz traffic and rising oil prices make it essential to distinguish a durable supply disruption from a temporary risk-premium shock. The research question is whether traffic is normalizing, whether the oil move is spreading into energy equities, and whether EIA inventory and supply data confirm a physical squeeze.

PRIMARY SOURCES / REPORTS:

- **Reuters — Hormuz traffic slows as uncertainty over waterway persists - Reuters** — Look for the causes of slower tanker traffic, transit conditions, and evidence of normalization.
- **Reuters — Oil extends climb on prolonged Hormuz export uncertainty - Reuters** — Examine the breadth of the oil rally, the supply-risk premium, and the market impact of export uncertainty.
- **EIA — Weekly Petroleum Status Report** — Check crude inventories, refinery utilization, production, and import/export data for evidence of a physical squeeze.

MACRO

Are yields and the tech selloff repricing the Fed path?

The technology selloff, higher Treasury yields, and a rising VIX suggest that markets are reassessing the discount rate for growth equities; the 10-year yield is at 4.706, while Nasdaq 100 futures and SMH are lower. The research question is whether the FOMC minutes will challenge the dovish interpretation implied by a 2026 median dot of 3.8, and whether a sustained move above 4.706 would further weaken risk appetite.

PRIMARY SOURCES / REPORTS:

- **Federal Reserve — FOMC Calendar & Statements** — Read the minutes for discussion of inflation, labor markets, the balance sheet, and the policy path.
- **US Treasury — Daily Yield Curve Rates** — Track the 10-year yield around 4.706 and changes across the rest of the curve.
- **CME FedWatch Tool** — Compare rate-cut and higher-for-longer pricing before and after the minutes.

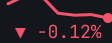
CRYPTO

Why are ETF inflows not fully translating into price action?

Bitcoin and Ethereum ETFs recorded inflows of 189.3 million and 71.4 million dollars respectively, yet Bitcoin's Coinbase premium remains negative, its four-hour trend is bearish, and BTC funding is negative. The research question is whether institutional spot demand is strong enough to overcome defensive derivatives positioning: a break above BTC resistance at 64,639 or below support at 63,378 would clarify the answer.

PRIMARY SOURCES / REPORTS:

- **Farside — Bitcoin ETF Flows (All Data)** — Check the August 18 total Bitcoin ETF inflow, fund-level flows, and whether the demand is persistent.
- **Farside — Ethereum ETF Flows** — Examine which funds generated the 71.4 million dollar Ethereum inflow and whether it is sustained.
- **Coinglass — Derivatives Data** — Compare negative BTC funding, open-interest changes, and liquidations with the ETF-flow data.

NASDAQ 100 29,460  ▼ -0.43%	DXY 99.5300  ▼ -0.12%	GOLD \$4,389  ▲ +0.52%	10Y UST 4.71%  ▼ -1.80%	VIX 15.8  ▲ +4.28%	BTC \$64,183  ▲ +0.10%	BTC.D 56.5% —	F&G INDEX 46 Fear
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TODAY'S CALENDAR

NEXT FOMC	MEDIAN DOT (2026)
Wed (28 days away)	3.80%

DATE	TIME (TRT)	EVENT	COUNTRY	PREV	CONS	ACTUAL
19 Aug Wed	21:00	• FOMC Meeting Minutes	USD	N/A	N/A	
20 Aug Thu	15:30	• Philly Fed Manufacturing Index	USD	41.4	24.1	

DATE	TIME (TRT)	EVENT	COUNTRY	PREV	CONS	ACTUAL
20 Aug Thu	15:30	● Unemployment Claims	USD	209K	210K	
21 Aug Fri	10:15	● French Flash Manufacturing PMI	EUR	50.0	50.1	
21 Aug Fri	10:15	● French Flash Services PMI	EUR	49.8	49.4	
21 Aug Fri	10:30	● German Flash Manufacturing PMI	EUR	52.2	52.1	
21 Aug Fri	10:30	● German Flash Services PMI	EUR	49.6	50.1	

EQUITIES & COMMODITIES

ASSET	PRICE	24H	7D	30D	TREND
● AAPL Apple	310.03	▲ +1.45%	▲ +1.68%	▼ -4.99%	
● MSFT Microsoft	481.63	▲ +0.27%	▼ -4.40%	▲ +19.72%	
● GOOGL Alphabet (Google)	344.20	▲ +0.06%	▲ +0.12%	▼ -2.21%	
● AMZN Amazon	259.45	▼ -0.71%	▼ -4.71%	▲ +3.78%	
● NVDA NVIDIA	219.74	▼ -2.34%	▲ +1.03%	▲ +8.10%	
● META Meta	543.67	▼ -4.45%	▼ -9.26%	▼ -15.82%	
● TSLA Tesla	336.87	▼ -0.72%	▲ +1.22%	▼ -8.85%	

ASSET	PRICE	24H	7D	30D	TREND
● XAU Gold	\$4,388.80	▲ +0.52%	▼ -0.46%	▲ +7.80%	
● XAG Silver	\$62.80	▼ -1.78%	▼ -4.20%	▲ +6.74%	
● HG Copper	\$6.46	▼ -0.37%	▼ -2.10%	▼ -0.81%	
● BZ Brent Oil	\$91.61	▲ +0.65%	▲ +2.96%	▲ +0.66%	

S&P 500 SECTORS

ENERGY XLE ▲ +1.76%	HEALTH CARE XLV ▲ +1.60%	CONSUMER STAPLES XLP ▲ +1.06%	FINANCIALS XLF ▲ +0.45%	COMMUNICATION XLC ▼ -0.31%	CONSUMER DISCRET. XLY ▼ -0.33%
UTILITIES XLU ▼ -0.36%	REAL ESTATE XLRE ▼ -0.45%	MATERIALS XLB ▼ -0.88%	INDUSTRIALS XLI ▼ -1.48%	TECHNOLOGY XLK ▼ -2.47%	

LIQUIDITY

FED BALANCE SHEET	STABLECOIN SUPPLY
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\$6.76T

▲ +0.17% w/w

\$254.7B

▼ -0.03% 24H

CRYPTO DESK

TOTAL MARKET CAP

\$2.28T

▲ +0.19%

BTC DOMINANCE

56.5%

24H TOTAL VOLUME

\$44.9B

TOTAL3 (EX BTC & ETH)

\$0.76T

Analyst Note: The 2Y-10Y spread is unavailable. Stablecoin total market capitalization declined 0.03% over 24 hours, while SMH fell 4.09%, pointing to modest liquidity softening and pronounced risk reduction in semiconductors.

DERIVATIVES DESK

\$64,183 ▲ +0.10%

Support Level

\$63,378

Resistance Level

\$64,639

Price at \$64,183 is holding above **support** (\$63,378), with **resistance** at \$64,639.

COINBASE PREMIUM INDEX — 7D

BTC/USD · Coinbase vs Global Spread (1H Bars)

-0.0327%

▼ US selling pressure

-0.033%

24h High

-0.106%

24h Low

+0.134%

-0.134%

07:00

16:00

01:00

11:00

20:00

06:00

Reading Guide: Positive values indicate US institutional buying pressure. Sustained positive premium is a bullish signal for BTC.

FEAR & GREED



FUTURES TERM STRUCTURE & POSITIONING

NEUTRAL

BTC BASIS ETH BASIS

BTC funding is negative at -0.1402%, while ETH funding is 0.7862%; with BTC open interest up 2.03% and ETH open interest up 3.82% over 24 hours, leverage remains active, although BTC positioning shows a short bias. Crypto futures basis data is unavailable, so the direction of futures premiums cannot be assessed conclusively.

BTC MAX PAIN (QUARTERLY)

\$70,000

DERIBIT DVOL INDEX

34.68 ▲ +0.25

OPTIONS PUT/CALL RATIO

0.56

FUNDING RATES (8H EQ.)

BTC	▼ -0.0014%
ETH	▲ +0.0079%
SOL	N/A

OPEN INTEREST (OI)

BTC	159.49M ▲ +2.03%
ETH	52.55M ▲ +3.82%
SOL	20.32M ▼ -2.28%

SPOT BITCOIN ETF FLOWS

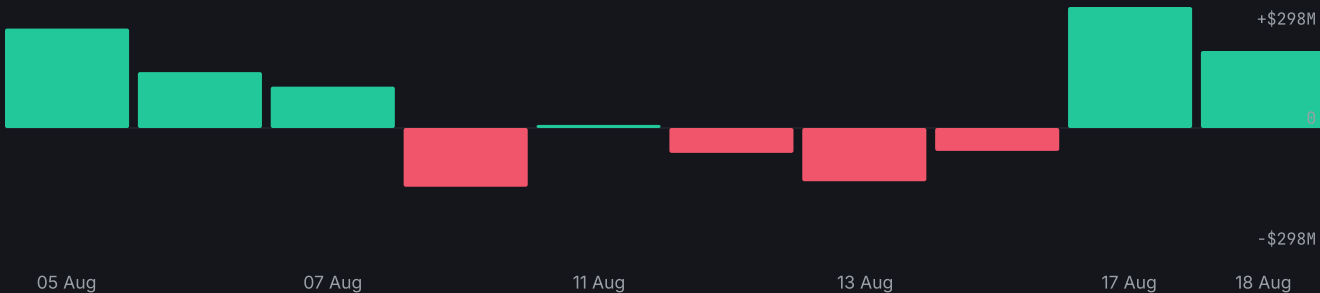
ETF Daily Net Flows

18 Aug 2026

MODERATE INFLOW

TOTAL FLOW	IBIT (BLACKROCK)	FBTC (FIDELITY)
+189.3M	+143.6M	+23.9M

SPOT ETF FLOWS HISTORY (LAST 10 DAYS)



Analyst Note: Spot Bitcoin ETFs recorded total inflows of \$189.3 million on August 18, including **\$143.6 million** into IBIT and \$23.9 million into FBTC. Positive flows indicate buying pressure, but under a risk-off regime their durability and the accompanying price response should be monitored together.

ETH Spot ETF Daily Net Flows

18 Aug 2026

MODERATE INFLOW

TOTAL FLOW

+71.4M

ETHA (BLACKROCK)

+64.7M

FETH (FIDELITY)

+0.0M

CRYPTO WATCHLIST

ASSET	PRICE	1H	24H	7D
● BTC	\$64,183.00	▼ -0.10%	▲ +0.10%	▲ +0.80%
● ETH	\$1,908.25	● 0.00%	▲ +0.80%	▲ +1.10%
● XRP	\$0.999287	● 0.00%	▲ +0.50%	▼ -2.00%
● SOL	\$76.7300	▼ -0.10%	▲ +1.30%	▲ +0.70%
● TRX	\$0.332833	● 0.00%	▲ +0.40%	▼ -0.40%
● HYPE	\$58.2200	▼ -0.50%	▼ -1.70%	▲ +6.90%
● DOGE	\$0.069892	● 0.00%	▲ +0.10%	▼ -3.00%
● LINK	\$9.6000	▲ +0.30%	▲ +2.00%	▲ +10.20%
● TON	\$1.3200	▲ +0.20%	▲ +0.60%	▼ -2.90%
● AVAX	\$6.3400	▼ -0.10%	▲ +0.80%	▲ +0.90%

TOP STORIES

REUTERS · 04:11

Pictures of the Day | August 18, 2026 - Reuters

AI Insight: The picture selection does not provide a direct market catalyst and therefore does not generate a meaningful financial signal.

REUTERS · 03:39

Hormuz traffic slows as uncertainty over waterway persists - Reuters

AI Insight: Uncertainty around the Strait of Hormuz raises concerns over energy-supply security; Brent at \$91.61 can reinforce inflation expectations and the risk premium, strengthening the risk-off tone alongside a negative Coinbase premium and a Fear reading.

REUTERS · 00:39

Oil extends climb on prolonged Hormuz export uncertainty - Reuters

AI Insight: The continued oil rally complicates the growth-inflation trade-off through higher energy costs. Spot Bitcoin ETF inflows of \$189.3 million and positive ETH funding offer partial support, but BTC funding at -0.1402% points to cautious positioning.

NOCASHFLOW bulletin.

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